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MySQL CREATE TABLE Statement

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The MySQL CREATE TABLE Statement

The `CREATE TABLE` statement is used to create a new table in a database.

Syntax

```
CREATE TABLE table_name (
    column1 datatype constraint,
    column2 datatype constraint,
    column3 datatype constraint,
   ....
);
```

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The *datatype* parameter specifies the data type of each column (e.g. varchar, int, date, etc.).

The *constraint* parameter is optional, and specifies rules for data integrity (e.g. primary key, not null, etc.).

Tip: Learn more about constraints in our MySQL Constraints chapter.

Tip: For an overview of the available data types, go to our complete Data Types Reference.

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MySQL CREATE TABLE

The following example creates a table with five columns:

Example

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```
CREATE TABLE Persons (
  PersonID int PRIMARY KEY,
  LastName varchar(255) NOT NULL,
  FirstName varchar(255),
  Address varchar(255),
  City varchar(255)
);
```

Example Explained:

- **PersonID** - This column is of type integer (int). This is also the PRIMARY KEY field, that uniquely identifies each row.
- **LastName** - This column is a variable-length character string with a maximum length of 255 characters (varchar(255)). NOT NULL specifies that this column cannot be empty.
- **FirstName, Address, City** - These columns are also variable-length character strings with a maximum length of 255 characters (varchar(255)). These columns allow NULL values by default.

The empty "Persons" table will now look like this:

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Tip: The empty "Persons" table can now be filled with data with the MySQL INSERT INTO statement.

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Create New Table From Existing Table

The `CREATE TABLE` statement can also be used to create a new table that copies some/all data from an existing table.

If you create a new table from an existing table, the new table will be filled with the values from the existing table.

Syntax

```
CREATE TABLE new_table AS
SELECT column1, column2,...
```

The following SQL creates a new table called "GermanCustomers" (which is a copy of the "Customers" table):

Example

```
CREATE TABLE GermanCustomers AS
SELECT * FROM Customers
WHERE Country = 'Germany';
```

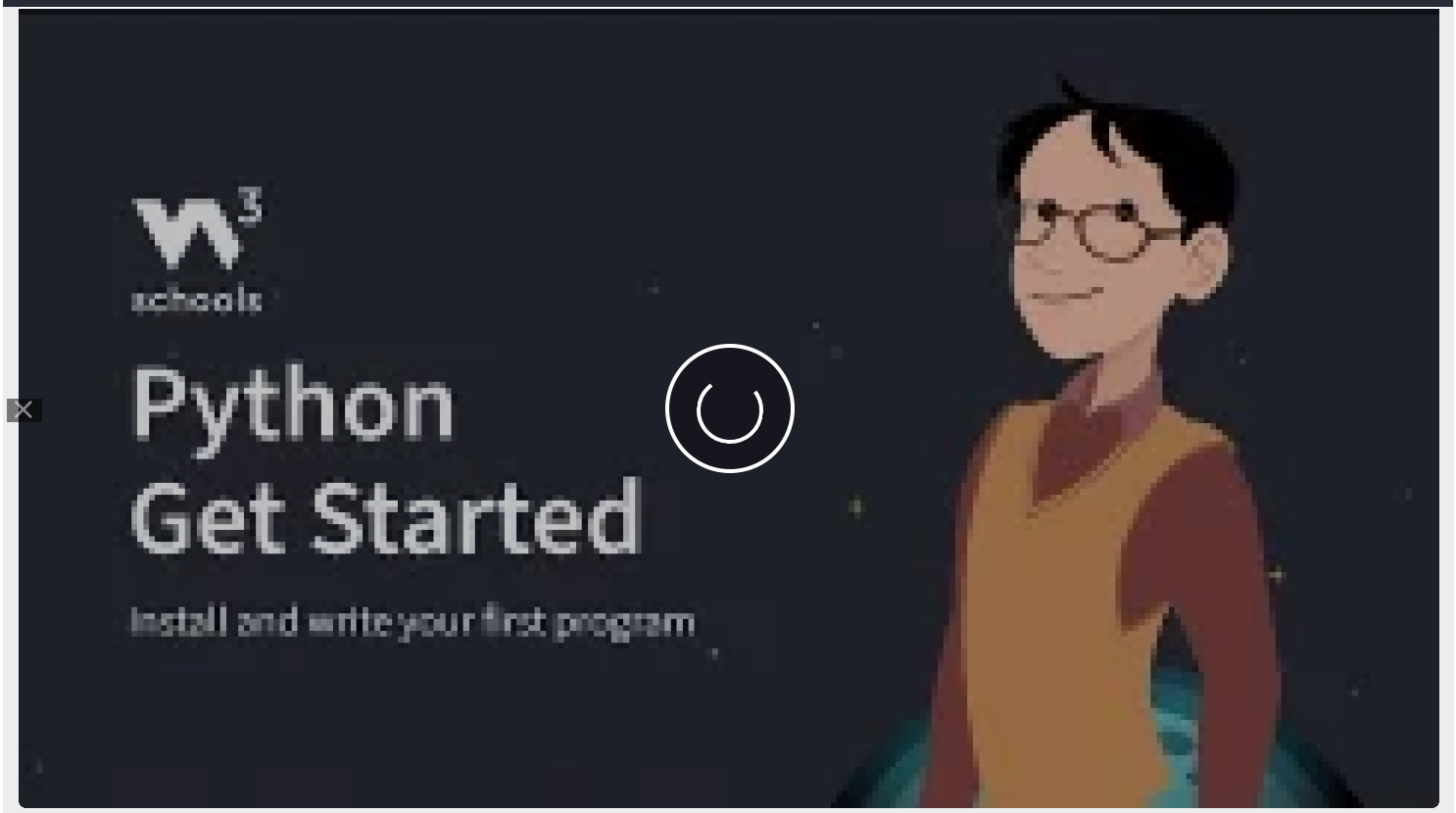
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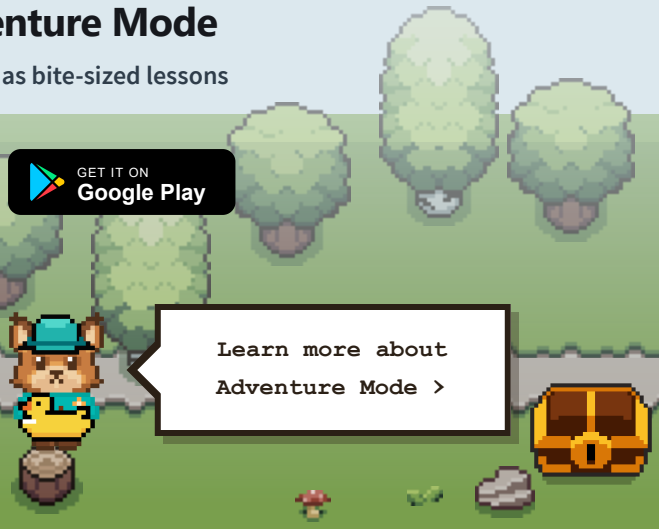
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